

JIDAI RACK User Manual

The Jidai Collection in one patchable rack · Martial Systems

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Back Panel Patching (after section 10), followed by the jack reference

1. Overview

JIDAI RACK is a rack cabinet in a plugin window. It holds the devices of the Jidai Collection and lets you cable any jack to any other, the way you would patch hardware modules:

Device	What it is
RACK I/O	The rack's connection to your DAW: host audio in, main audio out, MIDI as control voltages, and the host transport. One per rack, always at the top.
BUSHIDO	A 3 × 12 step sequencer with pitch CV, gates and a trigger for every step.
RONIN	A semi-modular synthesizer voice: VCO, resonant filter, two VCAs, two envelopes, MG (LFO), noise, ring modulator, sample and hold, and more.
RONIN FX	A RONIN that comes patched to take your track's audio at its EXT IN, ready to use as an effect.
ORIGAMI	A stereo triple wave folder.
SHOGUN	A drum machine with 14 drum voices and 2 synth voices (LEAD and BASS), a step sequencer and 151 jacks.

Every device is built into the one plugin, so cables carry signals sample by sample between all of them. Audio, pitch, gates and modulation all use the same voltages on every device, so any output can go to any input. You can add as many of each device as you like, except RACK I/O.



2. Quick start

Load a starter rack

1. Insert JIDAI RACK on a track in your DAW (section 7).
2. Click **RACKS ▾** in the header and choose a rack. **ACID ▸ Acid Line** is a good first one.
3. Press play in your DAW. The starter racks follow the DAW's tempo and transport.
4. Press **Tab** to flip the rack and see how it is patched.

Loading a starter rack replaces everything in the rack. Your DAW project saves the rack you are working on.

Build a rack from scratch

1. Choose **RACKS ▾ ▸ INIT** for an empty rack (RACK I/O only).
2. In the device browser on the left, click **BUSHIDO**, then **RONIN**. RONIN lands under BUSHIDO, already patched: row A's pitch and gate drive RONIN, and RONIN's output goes to MAIN OUT.
3. Press play in your DAW, or press BUSHIDO's start control, to hear the sequence.
4. Click **ORIGAMI** in the browser to add a folder, then press **Tab** and re-patch RONIN's output through it.

Use it as an effect

Choose **RACKS ▾ ▸ FX ▸ Filter Fold FX** on an audio track. Your track runs through RONIN's filter and ORIGAMI.

3. Panel reference

3.1 The window

The window has three parts: the **header** along the top, the **device browser** on the left and the **rack** itself. It opens at 1200 × 672 and can be made as small as 960 × 540. The rack scrolls when it is taller than the window.

3.2 Header

Control	What it does
FRONT / BACK	Shows the front panels or the back of the rack. Tab flips between them.
CABLES: ALL / HIDE PASS-THRU / SELECTED / HIDE	Cable view (see Back Panel Patching). K cycles through them. The front and the back each remember their own view.
FOLD ALL	Folds every device to its name strip, or unfolds them all. Same as Shift+F .
RACKS ▾	The starter racks, grouped as INIT, ACID, EDM and FX (section 6).
LAT	The rack's total latency in samples, as reported to your DAW.
Scale (for example 100%)	Click to step the window size through 75 %, 100 %, 125 %, 150 % and 200 %.
Notice	After loading a rack saved by an older version, a notice lists what was converted. Click it to dismiss it.

3.3 Device browser

The browser lists the devices by group: **SEQUENCER** (BUSHIDO), **VOICE** (RONIN), **DRUMS** (SHOGUN), **EFFECT** (RONIN FX, ORIGAMI) and **UTILITY** (RACK I/O). Each card shows how many of that device are already in the rack.

- Type in the search box to filter the list.
- **Click** a card to add the device at the bottom of the rack.
- **Drag** a card onto the rack to add it where you drop it.
- Hold **Shift** while adding to place the device without any automatic cables.
- Drag a device's strip back onto the browser to remove it.
- The « button collapses the browser to a thin strip.

3.4 Device strip

Every device has a strip along its top:

Part	What it does
▼ fold button	Folds the device to just this strip. Double-click a folded strip to unfold it.
Name and ID	The device's name and its rack ID (for example RONIN#1). Double-click the name to rename the device. Starter racks give devices names like ACID BASS.
OPEN / CLOSED	Front only. OPEN shows the full panel. CLOSED shows a 1 U strip of essential controls with no jacks. C toggles the selected device.
Badge <i>n cables · patch on BACK</i>	Shown on a closed device that has cables. Click it to flip to the back at that device.
Page tabs	The device's pages: BUSHIDO has MAIN, STEPS, CLOCK, MIDI and SETUP. ORIGAMI has MAIN, STAGES, DYNAMICS and SETUP. RONIN and SHOGUN have MAIN.
LAT	The device's own latency in samples.

Part	What it does
BYPASS	BUSHIDO and ORIGAMI only. Bypasses the device.
x	Removes the device and its cables. RACK I/O can't be removed.

Drag a device by its strip to move it up or down the rack. Click a device to select it. Its cables are highlighted in the SELECTED cable view, and F and C act on it.

3.5 RACK I/O (1 U)



Element	What it does
Transport display	Shows ► (playing) or ■ (stopped), the host tempo and the bar and beat. It shows NO HOST TRANSPORT if the host sends no position.
Meters IN L, IN R, OUT L, OUT R	Host audio coming in, and the main output going to your DAW.
MAIN knob	The main output level, from silence up to +6 dB (default 0 dB). Double-click to reset it.
LAT display	The rack's latency in samples. All paths into MAIN OUT are delayed to line up with the slowest one.

RACK I/O's jacks are on the back only (see Back Panel Patching).

3.6 BUSHIDO in the rack (3 U open, 1 U closed)



The full BUSHIDO panel, with its five pages. Every control works as it does in the BUSHIDO plugin. See the BUSHIDO manual for each control. Rack-specific points:

- **Pattern screen.** Banks **A** and **B**. Bank A is BUSHIDO's factory bank (section 6). Bank B holds your saves. **SAVE** stores the current panel as the next entry in the lit bank. Use the arrows or the menu to step through patterns.
- **Clock.** BUSHIDO can run on its own clock, follow the host, or take pulses at its CLOCK jack. The starter racks use the host clock.
- **MIDI.** BUSHIDO's MIDI settings still run, but the rack has no MIDI output port, so BUSHIDO plays devices in the rack through its jacks.
- **Pitch range.** BUSHIDO's pitch outputs start at C3 (0 V) and go up from there. For bass lines, set RONIN's VCO RANGE to 16' (one octave lower) or 32' (two octaves lower). The starter racks do this.

3.7 RONIN in the rack (4 U open, 1 U closed)



The full RONIN panel. Every knob and jack works as in the RONIN plugin. See the RONIN manual for each control. Rack-specific points:

- **Preset screen.** Banks **A** (RONIN's factory programs, section 6) and **B** (your saves). Loading a program sets RONIN's knobs and replaces the cables between RONIN's own jacks with the program's cables. Cables to other devices stay.
- **Rate.** RONIN runs at the rack's sample rate, so its jacks stay sample-accurate with the other devices. It reports 0 samples of latency.
- **HOST jacks.** Four back-only jacks connect RONIN to the rack's host audio (see Back Panel Patching).

3.8 ORIGAMI in the rack (3 U open, 1 U closed)



The full ORIGAMI panel with its four pages and its jack row. See the ORIGAMI manual for every control. In the rack:

- Every jack in the jack row is live, and four HOST jacks on the back route host audio in and out.
- **Preset box.** In the jack row, between VC 1 and VC 2: the same factory presets as the plugin (INIT and the RONIN, SHOGUN, BUSHIDO and GENERIC banks). The arrows step through them all; click the name for a menu grouped by bank. Loading a preset sets every control except BYPASS. The rack remembers the chosen preset with your project.
- **Sidechain.** Two back-only jacks, **SIDECHAIN** > **SC L** and **SC R**, are the plugin's sidechain input. If you patch both, ORIGAMI averages them to mono. Any stage whose VC SOURCE is **SIDECHAIN** follows the signal there. With **VCA SOURCE** on **CV**, a follower on the sidechain (timed by ATTACK and RELEASE) drives the VCA, unless a cable is patched into VCA CV, which then wins. With nothing patched into SC, a SIDECHAIN source is silent. The rack counts a sidechain cable as a signal path into ORIGAMI: if it comes from a delayed device (SHOGUN at 2×, for example), a **Δn** tag on the cables into ORIGAMI shows the difference (see 4.5).
- Latency is 0 samples at QUALITY 1× and 46 samples at 2×. The rack compensates for either.

3.9 SHOGUN in the rack (5.8 U open, 1 U closed, 4 U back)



The rack shows SHOGUN's MAIN page only. SHOGUN's other pages (VOICE, GRID, MOD, ROUTE, FX/MIX, SEQ/MIDI, GLOBAL) are edited in the SHOGUN plugin. Their settings are still part of a SHOGUN kit or patch, so a kit loads and plays complete.

Top row

Control	What it does
KIT display	The factory kit last loaded. Click it, or the PATTERN display, for SHOGUN's factory list: INIT and 21 kits, each with its own pattern. Loading a kit keeps SHOGUN on its current clock source.
PATTERN display	The current pattern's name.
◀ / ▶ (beside KIT or PATTERN)	Loads the previous or next entry in the factory list. The list wraps around.
⌕ (beside KIT or PATTERN)	Opens the factory list.
A / B	Two snapshots of the whole SHOGUN state: settings, kit and pattern. Click the other key to switch; the first time you switch to B, it starts as a copy of A. Right-click or shift-click a key to copy the other snapshot onto it. The lit key is the one you are editing; a dim key holds no snapshot yet.
↶ / ↷	Undo and redo, up to 64 steps. A knob turn, a key or step edit, a kit load and an A/B switch or copy are one step each. A key is dim when there is nothing to undo or redo.

A/B snapshots and the undo history last while the project is open. They are not saved with it.

CLOCK

Control	What it does
► (RUN)	Starts or stops the sequencer when SHOGUN runs on its own clock.
RST	Restarts the pattern at step 1.
INT / EXT	INT: the sequencer plays the pattern. EXT: the voices play only from their TRIG jacks.
TEMPO	SHOGUN's own tempo, shown in BPM. While SHOGUN follows the host, the host tempo is used.
SWING	Swing amount.
SCALE	Step length: 1/32, 1/16, 1/8T or 1/8.
BAR	Steps per bar (1-32).
STEP/BAR display	The bar and step being played, with ► or ■.

SYNC

Control	What it does
CLK IN	What a pulse at the CLK IN jack counts as when SRC is EXT, shown on the key: STEP (one pulse per step), or 1, 2, 4, 24 or 48 pulses per quarter note. Click for the next choice, right-click for the previous one.
SRC	The clock source, shown on the key: HOST follows your DAW's transport, INT runs on SHOGUN's own TEMPO (start and stop it with ►), EXT steps on pulses at the CLK IN jack. Click for the next source, right-click for the previous one.

A SHOGUN you add to the rack starts on SRC HOST: it plays while your DAW plays, in time with the song position. Switch to EXT to clock it from its CLK IN jack (see the Acid Drum Jam example).

MASTER

Control	What it does
ACCENT	How much accented steps stand out.
DRIVE	Drive on the master bus.
VOLUME	Master volume.
Meters, CLIP, LAT	Output level, a clip light, and SHOGUN's latency in samples.

VOICES

One column per voice: BD1, BD2, SD, RS, CP, CL, MA, CB, CH, OH, CY, LTC, MTC, HTC (drums), then LEAD and BASS (synths). Each column has three knobs, mostly TUNE (or FILTER, or CUTOFF and RESO on the synths), DECAY and LEVEL. Where a voice has no such knob, the space is left empty. Click a voice's name key to select its track for the step editor and hear the voice once.

STEPS

Control	What it does
16 step keys	Click to turn a step on or off. Shift-click turns it on as an accented step (or switches the accent). Right-click selects a step without changing it.
1-16 / 17-32	Which half of a 32-step track the keys show.
◀ TRK / TRK ▶	Selects the previous or next track.
Track display	The selected track, its length and its step scale (GLOBAL or its own).

STEP LOCKS (the selected step)

Control	What it does
ACCENT	Accent level of the step (3 levels).
FLAM	Flam amount.
RATCHET	Repeats within the step.
PROB	Chance that the step plays.
MICRO	Small timing offset, earlier or later.
BEND	Pitch bend of the step, on BD1, BD2, SD and the three toms.
NOTE	The note, on the LEAD and BASS tracks.

A step-lock knob that doesn't apply to the selected track (BEND on the other voices, NOTE on any drum) is dimmed and doesn't respond. | **COPY / PASTE** | Copies the selected track's steps and length, and pastes them into another track. | | **CLEAR** | Clears the selected track. | | **RANDOM** | Turns steps on at random on the selected track. |

The note under the step keys points to the full 16-track grid on the GRID page, which is in the SHOGUN plugin. In the rack, parameter locks from kits and patches play back as saved.

When closed, SHOGUN is a 1 U strip. On the back, its 151 jacks fill a 4 U plate.

3.10 Keys

Key	Action
Tab	Flip between front and back.
K	Next cable view.
F	Fold or unfold the selected device. Shift+F folds or unfolds all devices.
C	Open or close the selected device.
Esc	Cancel a cable drag, or clear the selection.
Delete / Backspace	Delete the selected cable.

4. Patching

4.1 Making cables

- **Drag** from one jack to another to connect them. While you drag, jacks that can take the cable ring green. A jack that can't tells you why (for example, two outputs).
- **Drag a plug** to move that end of a cable. Drop it away from any jack to unplug it.
- **Shift-drag** from a jack that is already patched to stack another cable on it.
- **Right-click a jack** for: *Connect to...* (a menu of every compatible jack in the rack, by device), *Disconnect* (or *Disconnect all*), *Cable colour*, and *Go to* → for each cable on that jack.
- **Right-click a cable** for its *Colour* and *Delete cable*.
- **Click a cable** to select it. **Delete** removes it.

You can patch on the front, where a device's panel shows jacks, or on the back, where every jack of every device is available.

4.2 How signals combine

- One output can feed any number of inputs.
- Several cables into one input are added together.
- **Feedback is allowed.** When cables form a loop, the newest cable in the loop is delayed by exactly one sample and tagged z^{-1} . Self-patching stays stable and sounds the same every time.

4.3 Signal types and colours

Every jack has a signal type, shown by the colour of its ring. A new cable takes the colour of the jack it comes from:

Colour	Signal	Level
Red	Audio	$\pm 5\text{ V}$ = full scale
Blue	1 V/oct pitch	0 V = C3 (130.81 Hz), +1 V per octave
Light blue	Linear Hz/V pitch (RONIN's HZ/V input)	1 V = C3
Green	Gate / clock	0 V off, 5 V on. Read as on above 1.0 V and off below 0.5 V.
Yellow	CV	modulation voltages
Purple	S-trigger (RONIN's envelope TRIG inputs)	Gates are converted for you

You can give any cable another colour (red, yellow, green, blue, white or orange) from its menu. Colour never changes the sound.

Warning badges. A $\neq$ badge on a cable warns that it joins jacks that don't match well:

- *linear Hz/V into V/OCT: not octaves:* the two pitch laws differ, so notes won't track. Use RACK I/O's NOTE output for V/OCT inputs and HZ/V LIN for RONIN's HZ/V input.
- *audio into a clock input:* audio will clock the input at its zero crossings.

A gate patched into RONIN's S-trigger input is converted automatically and gets no badge.

4.4 Automatic cables

When you add a device, the rack patches it for you:

Device added	Automatic cables
RONIN	Its output (HOST OUT L/R) to MAIN OUT. Placed directly under a BUSHIDO, it also gets BUSHIDO's row A pitch (CV A $\rightarrow$ V/OCT, or $\rightarrow$ HZ/V when row A is set to the linear law) and gate (GATE A $\rightarrow$ EG 1 TRIG).
RONIN FX	As RONIN, plus the host audio (RACK I/O $\rightarrow$ HOST IN) into its HOST IN, which feeds EXT IN.
ORIGAMI	Host audio into its HOST IN, and its HOST OUT to MAIN OUT.
SHOGUN	MIX L/R to MAIN OUT L/R. SHOGUN follows the host transport.
BUSHIDO	None (it has no audio output).

Hold **Shift** while adding to skip the automatic cables.

4.5 Latency compensation

Some devices delay their output: ORIGAMI at QUALITY 2× (46 samples) and SHOGUN at 2× or 4× oversampling (23 or 26 samples). The rack works out the delay on every path into MAIN OUT, delays the faster paths to line up with the slowest, and reports the total to your DAW. Cables into MAIN OUT show an amber **+n comp** tag when a path is delayed to match, and a **Δn** tag shows where paths into one input arrive at different times. The header's LAT shows the total.

A SHOGUN **RET** jack feeds audio into SHOGUN's mix through its oversampled output stage, so at 2× or 4× a signal patched into RET reaches SHOGUN's MIX twice SHOGUN's delay later (46 or 52 samples), while SHOGUN's own voices arrive after the single delay (23 or 26). The rack counts the longer path for MAIN OUT, but inside SHOGUN's mix the returned signal sits behind the drums. To keep an external voice tight with the drums, patch it to MAIN OUT next to SHOGUN's MIX and let the rack line them up.

5. MIDI and host sync

5.1 MIDI to CV (RACK I/O)

JIDAI RACK accepts MIDI notes on any channel. RACK I/O turns them into control voltages on four back-panel jacks:

Jack	What it sends
NOTE	Pitch of the held note, 1 V/oct, 0 V = C3. For V/OCT inputs.
HZ/V LIN	The same note on the linear Hz/V law (1 V = C3). For RONIN's HZ/V input.
GATE	5 V while any note is held.
VEL	Velocity of the latest note, 0–5 V.

It is a mono, last-note-priority keyboard. Playing a new note while holding another changes the pitch without retriggering the gate (legato). Releasing it returns to the previous held note. The rack doesn't send MIDI back out.

The starter rack **EDM > MIDI Fold Synth** is set up for MIDI playing.

5.2 Host transport (RACK I/O)

Jack	What it sends
CLK 1/16	A short pulse on every sixteenth note while the DAW plays, starting on the first.
RUN	5 V while the DAW plays.
RESET	A short pulse when the DAW starts playing.

The transport display on RACK I/O's front shows the host tempo and position.

5.3 Devices that follow the host

- **BUSHIDO** can follow the host clock (CLOCK page), or be clocked by CLK 1/16 at its CLOCK jack.
- **SHOGUN** follows the host transport as soon as you add it. It locks to the DAW's song position and plays while the DAW plays.
- **RONIN** and **ORIGAMI** don't use tempo. Clock them with patched gates, such as CLK 1/16 into a RONIN envelope (see the Tempo Gate FX starter rack).

5.4 Latency and automation

The rack reports its total latency to your DAW, and the DAW's delay compensation keeps the rack in time with your other tracks. The whole rack, with every device and cable, is saved in your DAW project.

6. Factory presets by bank

6.1 Starter racks (RACKS ▼)

Thirteen complete racks, every connection made with cables on the jacks. All of them follow the DAW's tempo where timing matters. To build EDM Starter yourself, cable by cable, see the JIDAI Patch Cookbook.

Group	Rack	Devices	What it does
INIT	INIT	RACK I/O	The empty rack.
ACID	Acid Line	BUSHIDO, RONIN	A 12-step acid line on the host clock, played on RONIN's ACID LINE sound. RONIN's INT slides between notes, the gate fires both envelopes (VCA and filter snap), and row C is the accent on the filter.
ACID	Acid Fold	BUSHIDO, RONIN, ORIGAMI	An acid line on RONIN's ACID SQUELCH sound, through ORIGAMI. Wired like Acid Line, and the filter snap (EG 2) also folds harder through ORIGAMI's VC 1. Row C accents steps 1, 5 and 10.
EDM	Driving Bass	BUSHIDO, RONIN, ORIGAMI	An 8-step rolling sixteenth bass. Step 9's trigger resets BUSHIDO, so its 12 steps play as an 8-step loop. ORIGAMI adds drive that keeps the low end clean.
EDM	Pluck Lead	BUSHIDO, RONIN, ORIGAMI	An 8-step pluck lead quantized to semitones, with the pulse width moved by RONIN's MG and a fast envelope on the filter.
EDM	Two Voices	BUSHIDO, 2 × RONIN, ORIGAMI	One sequencer plays two synths: row A is the bass, row C a counter line. RONIN 1's MIX sums both voices, and the pair plays through ORIGAMI.
EDM	Stepped Fold	BUSHIDO, RONIN, ORIGAMI	BUSHIDO sequences the fold as well as the notes: row C sets ORIGAMI's VC 1 on every step, and step 5's trigger kicks VC 3 once a loop.
EDM	MIDI Fold Synth	RONIN, ORIGAMI	Play RONIN from your DAW through RACK I/O's MIDI jacks (note, gate, velocity), through ORIGAMI.
EDM	Acid Drum Jam	SHOGUN, BUSHIDO, RONIN, ORIGAMI	Every device: SHOGUN plays a four-on-the-floor kit clocked from RACK I/O's transport jacks. A BUSHIDO acid line plays RONIN's ACID DRIVE sound through ORIGAMI. Drums and bass meet at MAIN OUT, lined up to the sample.
EDM	Full EDM Jam	SHOGUN, BUSHIDO, RONIN, ORIGAMI	Every device, host-clocked: SHOGUN plays kick, clap, hats, open hat, a tom fill and a lead riff on its LEAD synth. SHOGUN's whole mix runs through ORIGAMI. BUSHIDO's 8-step bass on RONIN joins at MAIN OUT, lined up with the drums.
EDM	EDM Starter	SHOGUN, BUSHIDO, RONIN, ORIGAMI	Every device, host-clocked and locked: SHOGUN plays kick, clap and hats, and its bar pulse (RST OUT) restarts BUSHIDO on every downbeat. BUSHIDO's acid line plays RONIN, ORIGAMI folds RONIN's filter before VCA 1, and the kick's envelope, turned upside down by RONIN's MIX, ducks the bass in VCA 1. The first recipe in the JIDAI Patch Cookbook.
FX	Filter Fold FX	RONIN, ORIGAMI	An insert effect: your track through RONIN's resonant filter swept by its MG, then through ORIGAMI.

Group	Rack	Devices	What it does
FX	Tempo Gate FX	RONIN, ORIGAMI	A tempo-synced gate: CLK 1/16 fires RONIN's envelope on every sixteenth note, chopping your track through VCA 1. ORIGAMI folds the result. Runs while the DAW plays.

6.2 BUSHIDO bank A (factory patterns)

INIT, ACID CIRCUIT, ACID GHOSTS, ACID SLIDE, ACID SEVENS, ACID VOYAGE, ACID SERPENT, ACID TUMBLE, GATED TRANCE, SWING HOUSE, TECHNO STABS, PROG PLUCKS, CALL ANSWER, HORIZON 24, FIVEFOLD ARP, ROLLING TEN, LINEAR LEAD, RATCHET ROLL, GLASS PLUCKS, ANTHEM LEAD, DEEP PULSE, BROKEN ARP (22 patterns).

6.3 RONIN bank A (factory programs)

INIT, then effects for audio at EXT IN (AUTO FILTER, ENV FILTER, TRANCE GATE, PUMP, S&H FILTER, RING MOD), acid basses (ACID LINE, ACID SQUELCH, ACID ACCENT, ACID PULSE, ACID DRIVE, ACID SLIDE), basses and leads (SUB BASS, OFFBEAT BASS, PWM LEAD, SIREN), drums (KICK DRUM, OFFBEAT HATS, NOISE SNARE) and effects (LASER ZAP, NOISE RISER): 22 programs. The effect programs need audio at EXT IN. Add the RONIN as **RONIN FX**, or patch RACK I/O > HOST IN into RONIN's HOST IN.

6.4 SHOGUN factory kits (KIT display)

INIT, Deep Round Kick House, Peak Time Warehouse, Metallic Industrial, Electro Body Pop, Dusty Broken Beat, Head Nod Boom Bap, Minimal Click Groove, Conga Groove, Half Time Pressure, Slow Ballad Brushes, Seven Eight Stepper, Polymeter Drift, Acid Line Workout, Breakbeat Rush, Two Step Shuffle, Lead Arp Sequence, Dub Echo Chamber, Rolling Hat Half Step, Shaker Percussion Circle, Jungle Break Roller, Lo-Fi Tape Wobble (22 programs). Each kit loads with its own pattern. In our tests at 120 BPM, the kits peak between about -10.4 and -7.4 dBFS at MAIN OUT.

6.5 Your own presets

BUSHIDO's and RONIN's bank B and any saves to bank A are stored on your computer and shared by every JIDAI RACK instance:

System	Folder
macOS	~/Library/BUSHIDO/ and ~/Library/RONIN/
Windows	%APPDATA%\BUSHIDO\ and %APPDATA%\RONIN\
Linux	~/.config/BUSHIDO/ and ~/.config/RONIN/

BUSHIDO's saves are in `user_patterns.json` and RONIN's in `user_presets.json`. Whole racks are saved in your DAW project.

7. DAW setup

JIDAI RACK is a VST3 effect that also takes MIDI input. A standalone app is included too.

Installing

Copy `JIDAI RACK.vst3` into your system's VST3 folder and rescan plugins in your DAW:

System	VST3 folder
macOS	~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/ or /Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/
Windows	C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\
Linux	~/ .vst3/

It appears under **Martial Systems**.

In any DAW

1. **As an instrument rack:** insert JIDAI RACK on an audio track (or an instrument track, if your DAW allows effects there). The sequencers and drums make the sound. No input audio is needed.
2. **As an effect:** insert it on the track you want to process. The track's audio arrives at RACK I/O › HOST IN.
3. **MIDI:** route a MIDI track or keyboard to the JIDAI RACK track or plugin. Notes arrive at RACK I/O's MIDI jacks.
4. **Tempo:** press play in the DAW. CLK 1/16, RUN and RESET follow the transport, and host-clocked BUSHIDO and SHOGUN play in time.
5. Keep the DAW's plugin delay compensation on.

Example: FL Studio

1. Copy the VST3 into your VST3 folder, then in FL Studio open **Options › Manage plugins** and click **Find installed plugins**.
2. Open the **Mixer**, select an insert track, and load JIDAI RACK into an effect slot.
3. To play it from the Piano roll: add a **MIDI Out** channel in the Channel rack and set its port number. In JIDAI RACK's plugin wrapper settings, under MIDI, set the input port to the same number. Notes in the MIDI Out channel's pattern now reach RACK I/O.
4. Starter racks follow FL Studio's tempo and play/stop. Press play in FL Studio to start them.
5. FL Studio uses the latency JIDAI RACK reports for its delay compensation.

Standalone

The standalone app uses your default audio input and output. Choose devices and a MIDI input in its audio settings. Without a host there is no transport, so RACK I/O shows NO HOST TRANSPORT. Run BUSHIDO and SHOGUN on their own clocks there.

8. Specs

Format	VST3 effect with MIDI input, plus a standalone app
Host I/O	Stereo in (HOST IN), stereo out (MAIN OUT; OUT R follows OUT L when only OUT L is patched), MIDI notes on all channels
Devices	RACK I/O, BUSHIDO, RONIN, RONIN FX, ORIGAMI, SHOGUN. Any number of each except RACK I/O (one).
Jacks per device	RACK I/O 11 · BUSHIDO 25 · RONIN 61 · ORIGAMI 14 · SHOGUN 151
Heights (open / closed / back)	RACK I/O 1 U · BUSHIDO 3 / 1 / 3 U · RONIN 4 / 1 / 4 U · ORIGAMI 3 / 1 / 1 U · SHOGUN 5.8 / 1 / 4 U
Cable processing	Sample by sample between all devices. Summing inputs. One-sample delay on the newest cable of a loop.

Signal levels	Audio ± 5 V. Gates 0/5 V (on above 1.0 V, off below 0.5 V). Pitch 1 V/oct with C3 = 0 V, plus linear Hz/V for RONIN.
Latency	Per device: ORIGAMI 0 / 46 samples (1 $\times$ / 2 $\times$), SHOGUN 0 / 23 / 26 samples (1 $\times$ / 2 $\times$ / 4 $\times$), others 0. Paths are aligned at MAIN OUT and the total is reported to the host.
Starter racks	13 (INIT, 2 ACID, 8 EDM, 2 FX)
Factory banks	BUSHIDO 22 patterns, RONIN 22 programs, SHOGUN 22 kits
Window	1200 $\times$ 672 default, 960 $\times$ 540 minimum, scale 75–200 %
Saved state	The whole rack (devices, settings, cables, views) in your DAW project. Racks from earlier versions convert on load.

9. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
No sound	Is anything patched into RACK I/O $\triangleright$ MAIN OUT (press Tab to look)? Is RACK I/O's MAIN knob up? Is the DAW playing? Host-clocked racks only play while the transport runs.
Sequencers don't play	Press play in the DAW. In the standalone app there is no transport: set BUSHIDO's or SHOGUN's clock to internal and start them.
SHOGUN doesn't follow my DAW	Make sure the DAW is playing. SHOGUN locks to the song position, so it starts with the DAW. A rack that clocks SHOGUN from its CLK IN needs cables from RACK I/O $\triangleright$ TRANSPORT.
MIDI notes do nothing	Route MIDI to the JIDAI RACK track (see section 7) and patch RACK I/O $\triangleright$ NOTE and GATE into a voice. Try EDM $\triangleright$ MIDI Fold Synth .
Wrong pitch, $\neq$ badge on a cable	A linear Hz/V signal is going into a V/OCT input, or the reverse. Use NOTE for V/OCT and HZ/V LIN for HZ/V.
Bass lines too high	BUSHIDO's pitch starts at C3. Set RONIN's VCO RANGE to 16' or 32'.
Clicks or distortion	Watch RACK I/O's OUT meters and SHOGUN's CLIP light. Lower levels, or turn down RACK I/O's MAIN. Several cables into one input add up.
Track out of time with others	Keep the DAW's delay compensation on. The rack reports its latency (LAT in the header).
I lost my rack after choosing a starter rack	A starter rack replaces the current rack. Use the DAW's undo, or reload the project.
Can't see a cable	Check the cable view (K). In HIDE PASS-THRU, long cables are stubs tagged with their far end. In HIDE, only plugs are shown. A closed device's cables are on the back.
A cable won't connect	Two outputs or two inputs can't be joined. The jack you drop on explains why it refuses.
Older rack looks different	Racks from earlier versions are converted on load. The header shows a notice of what changed.
A SHOGUN cable is missing after loading	Earlier versions of SHOGUN had a CLOCK $\triangleright$ FILL IN and a MOD $\triangleright$ LANE A jack that did nothing. They are gone, so cables on them are removed when the rack loads, and the notice says how many.

10. Legal

JIDAI RACK, BUSHIDO, RONIN, SHOGUN, ORIGAMI and the Jidai Collection are products of Martial Systems LLC. All other trademarks belong to their owners. See the LICENSE file that comes with JIDAI RACK for the full terms and notices.

Back Panel Patching

Flipping the panels

Press **Tab** or click **BACK** in the header. The whole rack turns around, and every device shows a generated rear plate:

- a cream **sticker** with the device type, its name and its jack count,
- a **role legend** (the colour key) and a **LAT plate** with the device's latency, on plates 3 U and taller,
- one framed **box per section** (VCO, VCF, OUTPUTS and so on), holding **every jack** of the device, including back-only jacks that the front panels don't show.

Each device has a fixed back height: RACK I/O and ORIGAMI 1 U, BUSHIDO 3 U, RONIN 4 U, SHOGUN 4 U. Cables made on the front appear on the back and the other way round. They are the same cables.



Rear jack roles and colours

Ring colour	Role	Typical jacks
Red	Audio	RONIN VCO/VCF/VCA outputs, ORIGAMI IN/OUT, SHOGUN voice OUT and MIX, RACK I/O HOST IN and MAIN OUT
Blue	1 V/oct	BUSHIDO CV A/B, RACK I/O NOTE, SHOGUN PITCH and NOTE, RONIN V/OCT
Light blue	Linear Hz/V	RACK I/O HZ/V LIN, RONIN HZ/V
Green	Gate / clock	BUSHIDO GATE A/B and step TRIGs, RACK I/O GATE and TRANSPORT, SHOGUN TRIG and clock jacks
Yellow	CV	BUSHIDO CV C, RONIN envelope outputs, ORIGAMI VCA CV and VC 1-3, SHOGUN DECAY/TONE/VEL
Purple	S-trigger	RONIN EG 1 and EG 2 TRIG, RONIN EXT IN GATE

Outputs have a light label under the jack, and inputs a plain one. The full list of every jack is in the jack reference below.

Back-only jacks and normalled connections

Some jacks exist only on the back:

Device	Back-only jacks	Behaviour
RACK I/O	all 11	HOST IN L/R (your track's audio), MAIN OUT L/R (what the DAW hears), MIDI NOTE/HZ/V LIN/GATE/VEL and TRANSPORT CLK 1/16/RUN/RESET.
RONIN	HOST IN L/R	Feed RONIN's EXT IN, the way host audio reaches the RONIN plugin. IN R follows IN L when only IN L is patched.
RONIN	HOST OUT L/R	What RONIN's OUTPUT section sends to the host: its MIX of the WET signal and the EXT IN signal.
ORIGAMI	HOST IN L/R	Feed ORIGAMI's IN L/R while those are unpatched.
ORIGAMI	HOST OUT L/R	The same signal as OUT L/R.

Normalled connections (signals that flow without a cable until you patch over them):

- **MAIN OUT R ← MAIN OUT L**: with only OUT L patched, you hear it in both speakers.
- **ORIGAMI IN R ← IN L**, and **ORIGAMI IN L/R ← HOST IN L/R** while IN L/R are unpatched.
- **RONIN HOST IN R ← HOST IN L**.
- **SHOGUN** voices play from their own sequencer until you patch their TRIG jacks and set INT/EXT to EXT. Each voice's OUT carries that voice on its own, and MIX L/R carries SHOGUN's whole mix.

Inside RONIN, the program's default routing is made of real cables (for example VCO → VCF → VCA → OUTPUT), which you see and can move on the back.

Cable view modes

The header's CABLES buttons (or **K**) choose how cables are drawn. The front and the back each keep their own choice:

View	What you see
ALL	Every cable as a rope.
HIDE PASS-THRU	Ropes only between jacks on the same device or neighbouring devices. Longer cables become short stubs tagged with the jack at their far end. Good for busy racks.
SELECTED	The selected device's cables at full strength, the rest faint.
HIDE	Plugs only, no ropes.



A cable whose other end is out of view (on a closed or folded device, or on the other side of the rack) is drawn as a tagged stub. Right-click the jack and choose **Go to →** to jump to its far end.

Worked example 1: Acid Line

RACKS ▾ > ACID > Acid Line, then Tab.



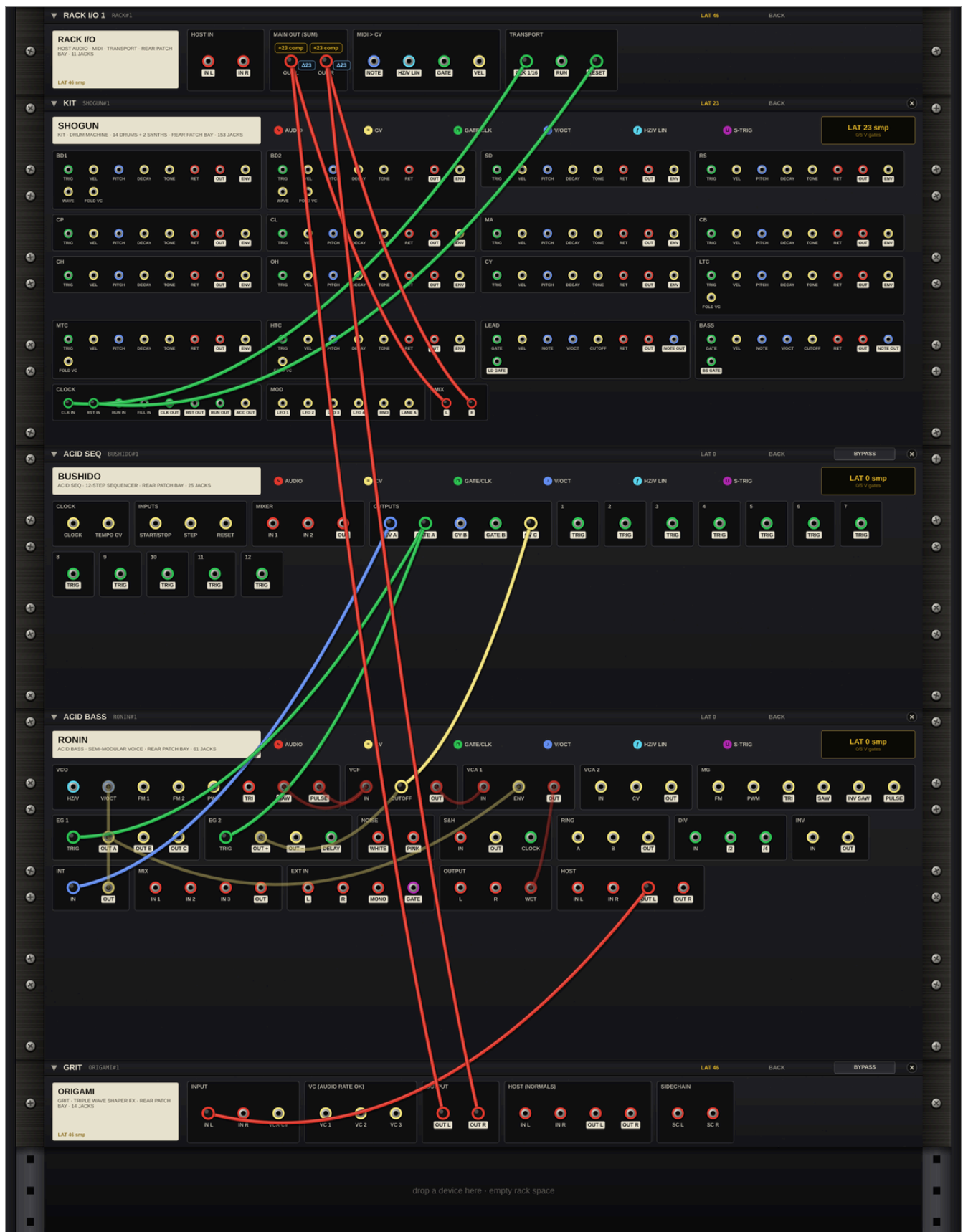
From	To	Why
RONIN is set like its ACID LINE program, but BUSHIDO plays it instead of RONIN's own MG pattern.		

From	To	Why
BUSHIDO > CV A (blue)	RONIN > INT IN	Row A plays the notes. INT smooths each step into the next: that is the slide.
RONIN > INT OUT	RONIN > VCO V/OCT	The slid pitch. VCO RANGE at 16' puts the line an octave below BUSHIDO's C3.
BUSHIDO > GATE A (green)	RONIN > EG 1 TRIG and EG 2 TRIG	Each step fires both envelopes (gate converted to S-trigger).
RONIN > EG 1 OUT A	RONIN > VCA 1 ENV	EG 1 opens the VCA.
RONIN > EG 2 OUT +	RONIN > VCF CUTOFF	EG 2 is the filter snap.
BUSHIDO > CV C (yellow)	RONIN > VCF CUTOFF	Row C is the accent. It sums with EG 2 on the same input (two cables on one jack).
RONIN > VCO SAW → VCF IN, VCF OUT → VCA 1 IN, VCA 1 OUT → OUTPUT WET		The voice path.
RONIN > HOST OUT L/R (red)	RACK I/O > MAIN OUT L/R	To the DAW.

Try this: turn RONIN's INT TIME down for a dry line with no slide, or up for a slower, rubbery slide.

Worked example 2: Acid Drum Jam (every device)

RACKS ▾ > EDM > Acid Drum Jam, then Tab.

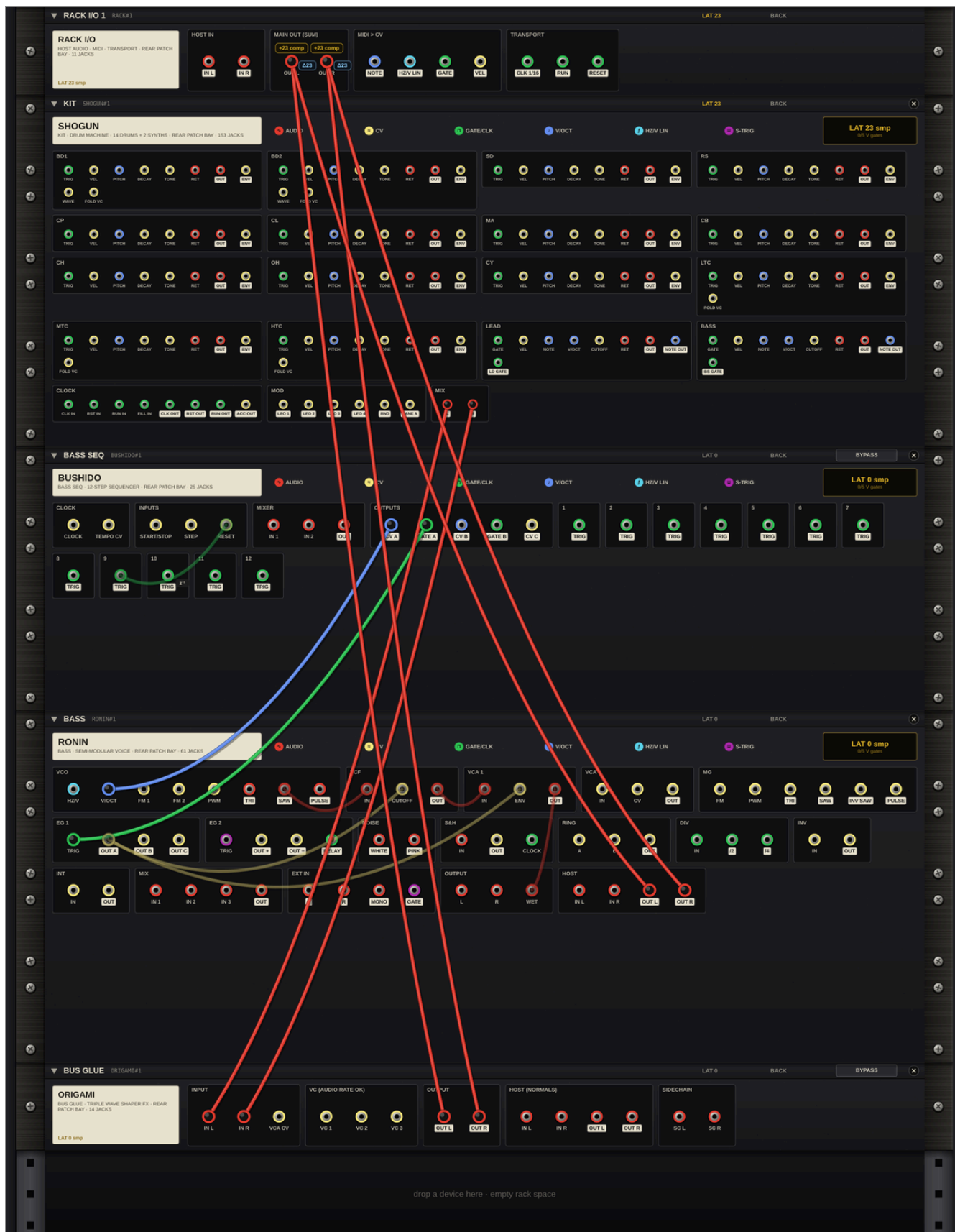


From	To	Why
RACK I/O › CLK 1/16 (green)	SHOGUN › CLOCK CLK IN	SHOGUN steps on every sixteenth note from the DAW.
RACK I/O › RESET	SHOGUN › CLOCK RST IN	Restarts SHOGUN's pattern when the DAW starts.
BUSHIDO › CV A, GATE A, CV C	RONIN › INT IN, EG 1 TRIG and EG 2 TRIG, VCF CUTOFF	The acid line, wired as in Acid Line. RONIN mixes its saw and pulse into the filter, as in its ACID DRIVE program.
RONIN › HOST OUT L	ORIGAMI › IN L	The bass through the folder (IN R follows IN L).
ORIGAMI › OUT L/R	RACK I/O › MAIN OUT L/R	The folded bass to the DAW.
SHOGUN › MIX L/R	RACK I/O › MAIN OUT L/R	The drums to the DAW.

The header's LAT (46) shows the time alignment at work: ORIGAMI runs at QUALITY 2× and delays the bass by 46 samples, SHOGUN at 2× delays the drums by 23, so the rack delays the drums by another 23 (the **+23 comp** tags on the SHOGUN cables). Drums and bass reach MAIN OUT together.

Worked example 3: Full EDM Jam

RACKS ▼ › EDM › Full EDM Jam: SHOGUN follows the host transport directly (no clock cables needed), SHOGUN's MIX L/R go through ORIGAMI IN L/R to MAIN OUT, and RONIN's HOST OUT L/R go straight to MAIN OUT. SHOGUN at 2× delays the drums by 23 samples, so the rack delays the bass by 23 to match (LAT 23). BUSHIDO's step 9 TRIG is patched into its own RESET input, which makes an 8-step loop from its 12 steps.



Worked example 4: MIDI Fold Synth

RACKS ▾ > EDM > MIDI Fold Synth plays RONIN from your keyboard: RACK I/O > NOTE → RONIN > V/OCT, GATE → EG 1 TRIG, and VEL → RONIN > MIX IN 2, where it adds to the envelope on the filter. Harder notes are brighter. RONIN's HOST OUT goes through ORIGAMI to MAIN OUT.



RACKS ▾ > FX > Tempo Gate FX on an audio track: **RACK I/O > HOST IN L/R → RONIN > HOST IN L/R (EXT IN) → EXT IN MONO → VCF → VCA 1. RACK I/O > CLK 1/16 → RONIN > EG 1 TRIG** fires the envelope on every sixteenth note, and EG 1 OUT A opens VCA 1, so your track is chopped in time. RONIN's HOST OUT runs through ORIGAMI to MAIN OUT.



Jack reference

Every jack of every device, by rear-panel section. "back" marks back-only jacks. RACK I/O's jacks are all back-only.

RACK I/O: 11 jacks

Group	Inputs	Outputs
HOST IN	–	IN L (audio), IN R (audio)
MAIN OUT (SUM)	OUT L (audio), OUT R (audio)	–
MIDI > CV	–	NOTE (V/oct), HZ/V LIN (Hz/V), GATE (gate), VEL (CV)
TRANSPORT	–	CLK 1/16 (gate), RUN (gate), RESET (gate)

BUSHIDO: 25 jacks

Group	Inputs	Outputs
CLOCK	CLOCK (CV), TEMPO CV (CV)	–
INPUTS	START/STOP (CV), STEP (CV), RESET (CV)	–
MIXER	IN 1 (audio), IN 2 (audio)	OUT (audio)
OUTPUTS	–	CV A (V/oct), GATE A (gate), CV B (V/oct), GATE B (gate), CV C (CV)
1 – 12 (one box per step)	–	TRIG (gate) on every step

RONIN: 61 jacks

Group	Inputs	Outputs
VCO	HZ/V (Hz/V), V/OCT (V/oct), FM 1 (CV), FM 2 (CV), PWM (CV)	TRI (audio), SAW (audio), PULSE (audio)
VCF	IN (audio), CUTOFF (CV)	OUT (audio)
VCA 1	IN (audio), ENV (CV)	OUT (audio)
VCA 2	IN (CV), CV (CV)	OUT (CV)
MG	FM (CV), PWM (CV)	TRI (CV), SAW (CV), INV SAW (CV), PULSE (CV)
EG 1	TRIG (S-trig)	OUT A (CV), OUT B (CV), OUT C (CV)
EG 2	TRIG (S-trig)	OUT + (CV), OUT – (CV), DELAY (gate)
NOISE	–	WHITE (audio), PINK (audio)
S&H	IN (audio), CLOCK (gate)	OUT (CV)
RING	A (CV), B (CV)	OUT (CV)
DIV	IN (gate)	/2 (gate), /4 (gate)
INV	IN (CV)	OUT (CV)
INT	IN (CV)	OUT (CV)
MIX	IN 1 (audio), IN 2 (audio), IN 3 (audio)	OUT (audio)
EXT IN	–	L (audio), R (audio), MONO (audio), GATE (S-trig)
OUTPUT	L (audio), R (audio), WET (audio)	–
HOST	IN L (audio, back), IN R (audio, back)	OUT L (audio, back), OUT R (audio, back)

ORIGAMI: 14 jacks

Group	Inputs	Outputs
INPUT	IN L (audio), IN R (audio), VCA CV (CV)	–
VC (AUDIO RATE OK)	VC 1 (CV), VC 2 (CV), VC 3 (CV)	–
OUTPUT	–	OUT L (audio), OUT R (audio)
HOST (NORMALS)	IN L (audio, back), IN R (audio, back)	OUT L (audio, back), OUT R (audio, back)
SIDECHAIN	SC L (audio, back), SC R (audio, back)	–

SHOGUN: 151 jacks

Group	Inputs	Outputs
BD1	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio), WAVE (CV), FOLD VC (CV)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
BD2	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio), WAVE (CV), FOLD VC (CV)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
SD	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
RS	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
CP	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)

Group	Inputs	Outputs
CL	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
MA	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
CB	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
CH	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
OH	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
CY	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
LTC	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio), FOLD VC (CV)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
MTC	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio), FOLD VC (CV)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
HTC	TRIG (gate), VEL (CV), PITCH (V/oct), DECAY (CV), TONE (CV), RET (audio), FOLD VC (CV)	OUT (audio), ENV (CV)
LEAD	GATE (gate), VEL (CV), NOTE (V/oct), V/OCT (V/oct), CUTOFF (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), NOTE OUT (V/oct), LD GATE (gate)
BASS	GATE (gate), VEL (CV), NOTE (V/oct), V/OCT (V/oct), CUTOFF (CV), RET (audio)	OUT (audio), NOTE OUT (V/oct), BS GATE (gate)
CLOCK	CLK IN (gate), RST IN (gate), RUN IN (gate)	CLK OUT (gate), RST OUT (gate), RUN OUT (gate), ACC OUT (CV)
MOD	–	LFO 1 (CV), LFO 2 (CV), LFO 3 (CV), LFO 4 (CV), RND (CV)
MIX	–	L (audio), R (audio)